How to Collect SMS Opt-In Consent the Right Way

Before you can text your contacts, they need to clearly agree to it. This guide shows you exactly what a compliant opt-in looks like with a real example form and a simple checklist.

The Compliant Web Form

Here is what a fully compliant SMS opt-in form looks like. Every element below is a carrier requirement. Use this Brightside Pest Control example as the model for your own signup page.

Full Name	Jane Smith
Mobile Phone	(555) 123-4567
☐ **Service updates**	Text me service and appointment updates from Brightside Pest Control
☐ **Deals & promos**	Text me deals and promotions from Brightside Pest Control
☐ **Terms & Privacy**	I agree to the Terms of Service and Privacy Policy
Fine print	Consent not required. Msg & data rates apply. Frequency varies. Reply STOP / HELP.

Split the Consent

If you send both transactional messages (reminders, account notices) and marketing messages (promotions, offers), you cannot cover them with one checkbox. Each type needs its own, plus a separate Terms acknowledgment.

Transactional SMS	Appointment and account texts with frequency and rate disclosures
Marketing SMS	Offers and promotions, plus "consent is not a condition of purchase"
Terms & Privacy	"I accept the Terms of Service and Privacy Policy" with links

Every opt-in must include

1. PHONE FIELD
Dedicated, clearly labeled, optional

2. CONSENT CHECKBOX
Unchecked; never pre-checked

3. BUSINESS NAME
Exact registered name in opt-in

4. MESSAGE TYPES
Describe what texts they will get

5. DISCLOSURES
Rates, frequency, STOP, HELP

6. TERMS & PRIVACY
Separate checkbox with links

#1 reason forms get rejected

A single checkbox covering all SMS types, or wording like "by submitting this form you agree to receive texts," will fail carrier review. Keep message types on separate boxes.

Privacy Policy That Passes Review

Your Privacy Policy must state plainly that you do not sell or share opt-in data. If it mentions "data sharing" without this clarification, your registration can get rejected. Include this language:

- Do not sell or share mobile numbers, SMS consent, or message data
- Share only with service providers to operate your SMS program
- Include frequency, rates, STOP, and HELP disclosures

Your Sample Messages Matter

When you register, you provide sample messages. They need your brand name and STOP/HELP language. Generic placeholders get rejected.

× **Too vague**	"Hi, check out our updates."
✓ **Compliant**	"Brightside: Appt confirmed Tue 3/12 at 10am. Reply STOP or HELP."

What Gets a Form Rejected

Avoid these and you will clear review the first time around.

- One combined checkbox covering all SMS types
- Pre-checked or missing consent boxes
- Consent implied just by submitting the form
- SMS consent hidden only inside Terms or Privacy links
- Missing STOP, HELP, business name, or rate disclosures

Pre-Submission Checklist

Run through this before you submit. If everything checks out, you are in good shape.

- Business name matches registration, website, and sample messages
- Dedicated, optional phone number field on the form
- Separate unchecked checkboxes for each message type
- Terms and Privacy links present with their own checkbox
- Sample messages include brand name and realistic content

Required disclosures

FREQUENCY
"Message frequency may vary"

RATES
"Msg & data rates may apply"

OPT-OUT
"Reply STOP to cancel"

HELP
"Reply HELP for help"

CONSENT
"Not a condition of purchase"

Need a hand?

Your Salesmsg team is happy to review your opt-in form before you submit. A two-minute check now can save days of back-and-forth with the carriers.